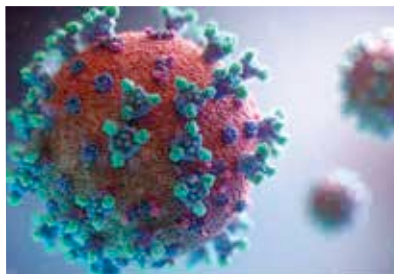


4 lakh coronavirus related cyberattacks reported in 2 weeks

Over 4 lakh Coronavirus-related cyber attacks have been recorded across the world, with hackers impersonating officials from WHO, UN and using popular apps like Microsoft Teams and Google Meet to attack victims, according to a report by TOI.

The FBI and the Department of Homeland Security also reported that organisations conducting research on COVID-19 are facing the ire of hackers linked to the Chinese government. According to research by Check Point Research, a global cyber threat intelligence bureau based out of Israel, around 20,000 coronavirus-related domains have been registered globally in the past three weeks, including in India. Out of them, around 2% (354) are deemed malicious while another 15% (2,961) are considered suspicious.



The theme “Corona Cure” has the largest number of domain registrations as compared to other relevant phrases like “post corona, corona crisis and corona relief payments.” The cyber threat intelligence firm is yet to segregate the domains by country, but they reported that there has been a 30 per cent increase in cyber attacks related to coronavirus in the past week.

For instance, one such attack is an email sent from a domain “who.

int” posing as WHO, with the email subject, “Urgent letter from WHO: First human Covid-19 vaccine test/ result update.”

The US Department of Justice said institutions that have received media attention for their work on COVID-19 should be prepared for cyber attacks and take the necessary precautions.

However, US did not cite any examples of the attacks but warned companies and organisations working on vaccines, treatments and testing to detect and fight the novel coronavirus to take additional measures to protect data and be aware of the potential threat.

The warning comes after a long-standing accusation by the US of China meddling in US companies and theft of technology and trade secrets.

<https://dgit.in/covidca>

Apple might shift large part of iPhone manufacturing from China to India

Apple may be considering moving as much as a fifth of its manufacturing capabilities out of China and straight into India. The report comes via Economic Times which reports that Senior Apple Executives have been in talks with senior Government officials to chalk out a plan for the expansion. The plan, however, has not yet been executed as there is a lot of work that remains to be done. According to the report, Apple will be seeking to scale up its production through its contract manufacturers, Foxconn and Wistron to roughly \$40 billion worth of smartphones. However, Apple would only need to produce \$10 billion worth of smartphones in India in order to reap the benefits of the production-linked incentive program that is being rolled out by the Indian Government. Currently, Apple manufacturers only \$0.5 billion worth of iPhones in India, while factories in China produce \$220 billion worth of products. The current government has been strongly pushing for indigenous smartphone production not just for sale within the country, but also for the purpose of export.

Apple's Make in India ambitions began with the iPhone SE and iPhone 6s being manufactured in India.

Recently, the Wistron factories started to assemble the iPhone XR in India as well, which corresponded with a notable reduction in the price of the phone.

The Coronavirus outbreak which started in China had brought the entire manufacturing machinery to a halt for



some time. This shutdown meant that every tech company which manufactures in China will have to come to terms with delays. Rumours have pointed out that the 5G ready iPhone 12 may be delayed by a month due to this very reason. The weakness of

this “Single-hub” manufacturing has never been more under the limelight and is the perfect time for companies to start diversifying when it comes to their manufacturing facilities. If Apple does come through in moving a fifth of its production to India, hopefully, we will see the more expensive iPhones also being manufactured here.

<https://dgit.in/aplmin>